GLOBAL TECHNOLOGY COMPETITION

Player Guide to the Rulebook

Name	Country	Portfolio

How to use this guide

This worksheet walks you through the rulebook. Focus on three things: what each number stands for, how your choices change those numbers, and what each choice costs you.

1. **Everyone** works through Part 1, the big picture.
2. Then work through the Part 2 section for **your portfolio**: Education, Immigration, Intelligence or Tech Strategy.
3. Discuss with your team before round 1.

> **TIP**
> Short notes are enough. If a prompt is hard, read the page listed and write down what you notice.

PART 1 · EVERYONE

The Big Picture

The numbers that describe your country

Copy your country's starting values from the table on page 5.

Number	What it stands for	Your country at start	Page
W	National wealth. It sets your budget: 2 × W dice each round.		4, 5
K	Your talent pool. Education and talent flow change it.		4, 5
TK	Know-how from doing research. It makes research pay more and multiplies your score.		4, 5
TP	Technology points. The main part of your score.	0	4
BR effective	The basic research you can draw on: your own, plus a share of your rivals'.	0	4, 9
IM	Your border policy: open or closed.		4, 5

Number	What it stands for	Your country at start	Page
Talent flow	How fast talent moves in or out of your country each round.		5, 12

How choices lead to outcomes

If you…	Then…	Page
Buy education	Your talent pool (K) grows. Talent adds extra basic research successes.	7, 15
Fund basic research	Your know-how (TK) grows. Harder research unlocks for you, and partly for your rivals too.	9
Fund applied research	You may earn TP. Harder levels pay more, but fail more often.	9–10
Send spies	You may learn or take a rival's TP. Your spy may also be caught.	11
Open or close borders	Talent flow and theft risk change.	11–12
Save dice	Your wealth (W), and so your future budget, grows. Savings in the last round are lost.	13

Walk-through

#	Prompt	Page	Your notes
1.1	Your score grows with three things. What are they? Which one do you think matters most? *Hint: Look at the score formula and the worked example.*	3, 14	
1.2	Read the steps of a round. Why does it matter that border changes happen before spies act? *Hint: Think about a country that closes its borders this round.*	6	
1.3	In the table above, which effects show up at once? Which build up over many rounds? *Hint: Compare applied research with education and saving.*	—	
1.4	Saving makes you richer later, but the GM does not announce the last round. What do you gain by saving? What do you risk?	13	

PART 2 · YOUR PORTFOLIO

Education

You build talent (K). Talent turns into know-how (TK) through basic research. For you, TK is an output.

Your key numbers

Number	What it means for you	Page
K	Your talent pool. The number you grow.	4, 15
Talent flow	Multiplies your whole K each round. It decides whether your talent grows or drains.	12, 16
TK	Know-how. Talent produces it through extra basic research successes.	9, 15

How your choices play out

If you…	Then…	Page
Buy SE	K grows. Countries with large populations gain more.	7, 15
Buy TE	K grows. It grows more if your borders are open.	7, 15
Have talent flow above 1	Your K, including new talent, grows every round.	12, 16
Have talent flow below 1	Your K, including new talent, shrinks every round.	12, 16
Have high K	Your team gets extra basic research successes, and so more TK.	9, 15
Have low K	M and H research pay less for your team.	9, 15

Education: walk-through

#	Prompt	Page	Your notes
E.1	Follow the chain on page 15. In your own words, how does a school turn into points? *Hint: Follow the arrows from "Buy SE or TE" to "Score".*	15	
E.2	Find your country's talent flow number. Is it above or below 1? What does that mean for the talent you build?	12, 16	
E.3	Compare your country with one other country in the table on page 16. Why does the same school have a different value?	16	
E.4	K matters most at certain levels. Is your country's K near one of them? *Hint: Look at the talent limits.*	9, 15	

Trade-offs to weigh with your team

■ Every die you spend on education is a die you do not spend on research or saving. When does education pay back?

■ Your choice works together with Immigration. Open borders make each TE purchase worth more.

PART 2 · YOUR PORTFOLIO

Immigration

You set border policy. It decides how talent moves and whether rivals can steal from you.

Your key numbers

Number	What it means for you	Page
IM	Your border policy: open or closed.	4, 12
Talent flow	How fast talent moves in or out of your country each round.	12
Theft risk	Whether a rival's spy can steal your TP.	11

How your choices play out

If you…	Then…	Page
Keep borders open	You can attract talent, and TE adds more K. Rival spies can steal from you.	11–12
Keep borders closed	Rival spies can still watch you, but they cannot steal. Talent inflow is limited.	11–12
Change policy	Your theft risk changes in the same round. Your talent flow changes from the next round.	12
(A rival changes policy)	Your own talent flow number can change too.	12

Immigration: walk-through

#	Prompt	Page	Your notes
I.1	Look at the table on page 12. Whose policy change moves the numbers most? Why might that be? *Hint: Think about which countries are rich and have strong universities.*	12	
I.2	If your team changes policy, what changes at once? What changes later?	12	
I.3	Talk with Intelligence: which rivals could steal from your country now?	11	
I.4	Talk with Education: how does your policy change the value of a TE purchase?	7, 15	

Trade-offs to weigh with your team

- Talent or security: open borders bring talent, closed borders keep your points safe. Which matters more for your country now?
- Your choice also changes your rivals' talent flow. Could that help or hurt you?

PART 2 · YOUR PORTFOLIO

Intelligence

You run the spies. You find out what rivals have, and you try to take it.

Your key numbers

Number	What it means for you	Page
Rivals' IM	Whether each rival is open or closed. It decides who you can steal from.	5, 11
Rivals' TP	Hidden until your spy observes or steals.	11
Public log	Shows rivals' basic research results and caught spies.	6, 9, 11

How your choices play out

If you…	Then…	Page
Spy on an open rival	You have a fair chance to observe or steal its TP.	11
Spy on a closed rival	You can observe its TP, but you cannot steal.	11
Spy on a harder level	The prize is bigger, but your spy is more likely to be caught.	11
Get caught	All teams learn that your country sent a spy.	11

Intelligence: walk-through

#	Prompt	Page	Your notes
N.1	Read the results table on page 11. As the level goes from L to H, what changes?	11	
N.2	Why are open countries better targets than closed ones?	11	
N.3	If your spy is caught, every team finds out. How might other teams react? *Hint: Think about trust, deals and revenge.*	11	
N.4	Which rival, and which level, looks worth a spy? What clues does the public log give you? *Hint: Basic research is public.*	6, 9, 11	

Trade-offs to weigh with your team

- Information or exposure: each spy can teach you something, but it can also reveal what your country is doing.
- Each spy costs a die that could go to research or saving.

PART 2 · YOUR PORTFOLIO

Tech Strategy

You turn dice into technology points through basic and applied research. For you, TK is an input: high TK makes M and H research pay more.

Your key numbers

Number	What it means for you	Page
BR effective	Your basic research plus a share of your rivals'. It unlocks M and H.	9
TK	Know-how. More TK makes the big rewards at M and H more likely.	9–10
TP	Technology points. Your main output.	9, 14

How your choices play out

If you…	Then…	Page
Fund basic research	TK grows, and M and H unlock sooner. Rivals gain a share of it too.	9
Buy L dice	A safe, small reward.	9–10
Buy M or H dice	More risk, bigger rewards. High TK makes the big reward more likely.	9–10
Buy many AR dice in one round	Each extra die costs more than the one before.	8
Reach a level's cap	You cannot buy more dice at that level.	9

Tech Strategy: walk-through

#	Prompt	Page	Your notes
T.1	Look at the outcome trees on page 10. Describe L, M and H in one phrase each. *Hint: For example: "safe, small reward".*	10	
T.2	Basic research helps rivals as well as you. Could your team let others pay for it?	9	
T.3	Why might you spread applied research across rounds instead of buying it all at once?	8	
T.4	What should be true before your team bets on H research? *Hint: Look at what unlocks H and what makes its big reward likely.*	9–10	

Trade-offs to weigh with your team

- Safe or risky: L pays a little often, H pays a lot rarely. Where is your team on that scale?
- Research now or save now: dice saved today become a bigger budget later, if the game lasts.

PART 3 · YOUR TEAM

Bring It Together

Meet with your team. Each member reports for one minute on their portfolio. Then discuss these questions.

#	Prompt	Page	Your notes
3.1	What is the one number each portfolio will watch most closely?		
3.2	Where do two portfolios want the same dice? How will you decide?		
3.3	How much will you save in round 1, and why?		
3.4	Will your country be open or closed? Who will you spy on first?		
3.5	What is your plan for round 1, in one sentence?		